

HUM 2101: Sociology and Disaster Management

Social research methods and key sociology terms

Lecture 5.1

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Society

- The term society is derived from the Latin word 'socius', which means companionship or friendship.
- Two primary components of a society are its culture and its social structure.
- Society is a large grouping that shares the same geographical territory, shares a common culture and social structure, and expected to abide by the some laws.



Community

- A community is a group of people living in the same place or having a particular characteristic in common such as norms, religion, values or identity.
- It is a group of people who share the same things, such as: where they live, work and play
- It is also a place where people solve problems together.



Association

- Association means pursuing ends.
- Association is a relationship between two objects. In other words, association defines the multiplicity between objects.
- You may be aware of one-to-one, one-to-many, many-to-one, many-to-many all these words define an association between objects.



Difference between society and association

Society	Association
Originally society is prior to association. It is older than association.	Originally association is later to society. It is younger than society.
Society may be organized or unorganized	Association is always organized
Society is formed for welfare of mass	Association is formed to fulfill some goals or needs
Society is permanent	Association is temporary in nature. In some cases, it's permanency is relative.
Society is natural	Association is temporary in nature
Society is a complex web of social relationship	Association is a collection of individuals
Membership is compulsory	Membership is voluntary.

Institution

- A social institution may be defined as an organizational system which functions to satisfy basic social needs by providing an ordered framework linking the individual to the larger culture.



Difference between association and community

Association	Community
Membership of an association is voluntary. Individuals are at liberty to join them.	By birth itself, individuals become members of community. In this way, membership is rather compulsory.
An association has some specific interest or interests.	A community has some general interests.
An association does not necessarily imply the spatial objects.	A community is marked by locality.
An association may be stable and long-lasting or it may not be so.	A community is relatively more stable and permanent.

Difference between association and institution

Association	Institution
An association is a group of people organized for the purpose of fulfilling a need or needs	Institution refers to the organized way of doing things. It represents common procedure.
It denotes membership. We belong to associations, political parties, trade unions, youth clubs, families etc.	It denotes only a mode or means of service.
It consists of individuals	It consists of laws, rules and regulations
They are concrete	They are abstract
An association has a location. It makes sense to ask where it is. Thus, a family can be located in space	It does not have locations